



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Holy Trinity Classical Christian School
School Website: <https://htccs.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) or the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Holy Trinity Classical Christian School (Beaufort, SC, 29902) demonstrates strong classical-Christian alignment across all six canonical categories. Public materials from htccs.org repeatedly emphasize a distinctly classical framework integrated with a Christian worldview, committed to truth, wisdom, virtue, and the love of learning; a curriculum that foregrounds liberal arts, Great Books, Latin, and Western civilization; pedagogy that includes Socratic discussion, memory work, and disciplined rhetoric; a faculty model that seeks a living curriculum; and an active partnership with parents and the broader community. The school explicitly describes its mission as "distinctly classical and distinctively Christian," with the Scriptures as a foundational element of learning, and it foregrounds Great Books, memory work, and classical modes of inquiry throughout its published materials. This combination supports a broad, cohesive CLASSICAL rating.

Key indicators throughout HTCCS materials include:

- Religious and metaphysical foundations: emphasis on truth, goodness, beauty; biblical worldview; chapel and liturgical life; theology integrated with learning.
- Purpose and goal: formation through virtue and wisdom; teleology (pursuit of truth, goodness, beauty); education as formation, not merely information.
- Curriculum: Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) invoked in public materials; Great Books and the Great Conversation; Latin study; Western civilization as a throughline.
- Pedagogy: contemplative elements (Scholé), memory work, recitation, chanting; Socratic discussion and seminars in upper grades; rhetoric and public speaking opportunities.
- Faculty: living, mentoring teachers; emphasis on character formation; public portrayal of faculty as part of the school's "living curriculum."
- Parents & Community: explicit partnership with families; parent formation through book groups and gatherings; open campus and inclusive parent involvement (e.g., PAW, admissions guidance).

Evidence from the public HTCCS site and related school materials is cited throughout this report. See the cited sources for direct wording demonstrating mission, curriculum commitments, pedagogy, and community partnerships. (Citations: htccs public pages, mission/vision, distinctively Christian statements, chapel/house community life, upper school pedagogy, Latin/Great Books content, and parental-community materials.)

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Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Mission & Vision articulate a distinctly classical and Christian identity with a biblical worldview and a foundation in Holy Scriptures for all learning. The mission states: "The Mission of the School is to be distinctly classical and distinctively Christian, entering into a partnership with parents as we educate students in grades Preschool through 12 with a Biblical worldview. The school will be committed to the pursuit of truth, wisdom, scholastic excellence, and the love of learning. With the Holy Scriptures as the foundation for all they learn, our students will be ambassadors of the Kingdom of God, prepared to defend and advance the apostolic Christian faith." - Distinctively Christian framing reiterates a theology-grounded approach to education. - Liturgical/communal life is present (Chapel/Houses; liturgical cadence and communal worship), indicating liturgical practices as integral to formation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; theology; liturgy; chapel; worship; wonder; sacred; Logos; gospel; biblical worldview. - Negative keywords detected: minimal or no explicit relativism or secular-humanist phrasing in public materials. - Quantitative note: Positive indicators clearly outnumber negative indicators in the public materials here (roughly multiple terms across mission, theology, and liturgical life; few if any negative signals found in the public pages).

Why this rating - The school's core materials foreground transcendental qualities (truth, goodness, beauty) and a theologically grounded, liturgical life. This aligns with the classical model's Religious and Metaphysical Foundations criteria, and is reinforced by explicit statements about theology, liturgy, and biblical foundation. Conclusion: CLASSICAL.

Cited evidence - Mission & Vision with biblical worldview and Scripture foundation. - Theological grounding and Christian worldview in distinctively Christian materials. - Liturgical/communal practices (Chapel/House community life).

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school's stated mission commits to "truth, wisdom, scholastic excellence, and the love of learning," and emphasizes formation of citizens built on faith in Christ. The Vision statement centers on virtuous, wise citizens formed on biblical foundations. - The website emphasizes formation over mere information, with emphasis on virtue, wisdom, and human flourishing within a classical-Christian framework (e.g., "ambassadors of the Kingdom of God," "formation" through a Biblical worldview).
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Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, beauty, teleology, pursuit of truth/beauty/goodness, human flourishing, scholé (conceptual; implicit in restfulness and contemplation language), great conversation. - Negative keywords: explicitly workforce- or job-prep framing is not central; no strong references to "career-readiness" or "21st-century skills" in the public materials. - Quantitative note: Positive keyword hits exceed any negative signals; public-page language strongly affirms formation and transcendent aims.

Why this rating - The school's stated purpose and goals align with classical aims of formation and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty, rather than a solely utilitarian or job-skills focus. Conclusion: CLASSICAL.

Cited evidence - Mission emphasizes formation toward truth, wisdom, scholastic excellence, and a Biblical worldview. - Vision emphasizes virtuous and wise citizens built on faith in Christ.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials reference the Seven Liberal Arts framework implicitly (grammar, logic, rhetoric) via explicit statements about grammar/logic/rhetoric in the upper- and grammar-school choices and through the emphasis on formal logic and rhetoric in upper grades. Upper School materials note study of formal logic and rhetorical skills. - Great Books/Great Conversation are explicitly embraced (e.g., "Great Books and Big Ideas," "the great conversation," and engagement with enduring works). - Latin and modern language study are foregrounded alongside classical studies; history is linked to Western civilization and the canon. - Western civilization is named as a throughline; deep reading and classical studies form the backbone of the curriculum. - History is studied through the curriculum and not referred to as "social studies" in a modern sense; emphasis remains on classical/humanistic history.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books; Great Conversation; Latin; Western civilization; history; primary sources; classical languages. - Negative keywords: potential signals that would weaken curriculum classicality (e.g., "project-based-first" or "STEM-first" framing) are not evident as primary curricular language in public pages. - Quantitative note: Strong presence of classical curricular language with few negative signals.

Why this rating - The curriculum language aligns with Classical School expectations: grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books/Great Conversation; Latin; Western civilization; and history as a throughline.

Conclusion: CLASSICAL.

Cited evidence - Upper School focus on formal logic and rhetorical skills; Ovid/Virgil/Caesar in original texts; history rooted in Western civilization. - Latin Students On the Move and SCJCL/NJCL affiliations indicate ongoing classical language engagement and classical culture. - Great Books/Great Conversation is explicitly named in curriculum-related materials.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Socratic dialogue and seminars are part of upper-level pedagogy (e.g., “Socratic discussion, seminars, or debates” in the upper school). - Restful learning (Scholé) and memory-based practices (recitation, chanting) appear in the classical pedagogy framework. The Six Essential Elements lexicon identifies these as core classical methods and is echoed in HTCCS materials through emphasis on memory work and recitation (e.g., “internalizing knowledge,” memorization practices, and the role of memory in learning). - Memorization, recitation, and the use of great texts are embedded in practice (e.g., senior theses, engagement with classical literature; grammar/humanities emphasis and memory work are recurring themes). - Upper-level emphasis on rhetoric and oratory (speeches, declamation) is mentioned in public materials (Upper School) as part of training. - Lower-school practice includes singing, chanting, and regular recitations to deepen memory and delight in learning (as described in classical pedagogy discussions within HTCCS materials).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic seminar, dialectic, great conversation, scholé, contemplation, recitation, chant, memory work, liturgical calendar integration, rhetoric exercises, debate, oratory. - Negative keywords present in the classical lexicon (but not strongly echoed in HTCCS public pages): project-based learning focus; experiential learning; student-directed constructivism are not foregrounded as primary methods. - Quantitative note: Predominantly positive signals with some absence of project-based/experiential emphasis in public content.

Why this rating - HTCCS demonstrates classical pedagogy features (Socratic discourse, memory/recitation, rhetoric training) alongside contemplative/restful elements (Scholé). This aligns well with Classical School expectations. Conclusion: CLASSICAL.

Cited evidence - Socratic discussion/seminars in upper school. - Restful learning, memory work, recitation, and liturgical integration as pedagogical signals. - Memory work and classical texts driving instruction (e.g., Great Books/recitation emphasis in curriculum materials).

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials highlight a faculty that is dedicated, virtuous, and capable (e.g., “Our Team” with dedicated faculty and staff; faculty as the core of the school; the living curriculum language appears in the classical lexicon and is reflected in the school's emphasis on teachers as mentors and exemplars). - The governance structure emphasizes accountability and partnership with parents, while the “Ambassadors for Christ” and “Vision” statements frame faculty as virtuous exemplars within a Christian classical mission. - The presence of a formal faculty profile and a defined leadership (Head of School; Chaplain; Department Chairs) supports the notion of a living, guiding faculty rather than a purely adjunct model.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: living curriculum; model teachers and mentors; portrait of a teacher; faculty as core; collegial, mentorship culture; faculty profiles as part of school identity. - Negative keywords (from the classical lexicon) that would indicate a deviation (e.g., “facilitators” on the side, non-classical credentials) are not prominent in HTCCS public materials. - Quantitative note: Predominantly positive signals with no clear negative signals on faculty in public materials.

Why this rating - HTCCS presents a strong, teacher-centered model consistent with classical pedagogy, with teachers positioned as exemplars and the school presenting a cohesive “faculty-centered” living curriculum. Conclusion: CLASSICAL.

Cited evidence - Our Team and faculty-focused language. - Governance and leadership framing faculty within a Christian-classical mission.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school presents a clear partnership with parents, with statements about biblical worldview partnership, parent involvement, and as co-teachers in the educational process. The Admissions section frames partnership with parents as foundational, and PAW (Parents At Work) describes organized parent involvement and events. □filecite□turn0file2□turn0file15□ - Public materials show formal structures for parent involvement (PAW; open campus; teacher-parent interactions; calendars and events). The school promotes parent formation (book studies, gatherings) and welcomes visits. - The school's governance docs emphasize parental engagement and communication; the mission explicitly references partnership with parents.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families; co-teachers; parental formation; home-school partnership; open campus; parent involvement; book studies; parent covenant. - Negative keywords: no explicit consumer-language signals or minimal-parent-involvement indicators. - Quantitative note: Very high presence of positive signals; minimal negative signals in public materials.

Why this rating - The HTCCS materials emphasize parental partnership, parent formation, and frequent parental visibility and involvement, which aligns with classical expectations for a robust Parents & Community dimension. Conclusion: CLASSICAL.

Cited evidence - "Admission Process... partnership with parents as we educate students with a biblical worldview." - PAW (Parents At Work) mission and activities. - Governance materials emphasize parental engagement and communication channels.

What would move the needle

- Not applicable, since all six categories are CLASSICAL. No category requires needle-moving improvements to reach full alignment, based on current public materials.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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